for the tram to rattle over the tracks, she wondered what to tell Rose.

As she crossed the street, stepping over the metal rails, Léa decided she would wait to tell her sister she'd lost her job. After what had happened at the quai, Rose didn't need another thing to worry about. All Léa had ever wanted was for Rose to be able to pursue her drawing. At first, it was for practical reasons: it was easier to give Rose a pencil and paper when her mother asked her to look after her, and she'd be content and still. But when Maman got sick, Rose had been the one to sit next to her, filling sketchbooks with her mother's fragile hands and face, including sketching her through tears on the day she died. Under the bed, Léa kept the four sketchbooks from that time of all the things they both treasured—the memories of the last weeks of their mother's life.

Sometimes Léa would take them out and look at them. She'd seen the improvement in Rose's skill, how she captured not only her mother's likeness but her spirit. How had she done it? Léa knew Rose had talent. She'd promised their mother that she would do everything to help her sister's dreams come true. Once the war was over, Léa was determined that Rose would attend the L'École des Beaux-Arts and become a professional artist.

She'd saved enough cash to cover next month's rent. She'd find a job and figure a way out of this just as she had every problem she and Rose had faced. With every bone in her body, she wanted to shield her sister from the reality of the war, while keeping a good heart.